Critical HIPAA Terms

HIPAA learning reference

Protected Health Information PHI

Individually identifiable information that relates to a person’s health, health care, or payment for health care.

Electronic Protected Health Information ePHI

PHI that is created, received, maintained, or transmitted electronically.

Privacy Rule

Sets standards for how PHI may be used and disclosed and establishes patient privacy rights.

Security Rule

Requires administrative, physical, and technical safeguards to protect ePHI confidentiality, integrity, and availability.

Breach Notification Rule

Requires notices after certain breaches of unsecured PHI. Workforce members report suspected incidents; designated teams assess and notify.

Covered Entity and Business Associate

Covered entities include health plans, clearinghouses, and qualifying providers. Business associates perform services involving PHI for a covered entity.

Minimum Necessary

When it applies, use, disclose, or request only the PHI needed for the purpose. It generally does not apply to provider-to-provider treatment disclosures or requests.

Patient Rights

Individuals may have rights to access records, request amendment, receive an accounting of disclosures, and request confidential communications.

Workforce Responsibilities

Use approved systems, protect passwords, avoid phishing, safeguard your workspace, access only what your job requires, and report suspected incidents promptly.

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